

[South America](#) > [Brazil](#) > [Southeast \(Brazil\)](#) > [Rio de Janeiro \(state\)](#) > [Grande Rio](#) > Rio de Janeiro

Rio de Janeiro

Rio de Janeiro is the second largest city in [Brazil](#), on the South Atlantic coast. Rio is famous for its breathtaking landscape, its laid-back beach culture and its annual carnival. The "Carioca Landscapes between the Mountain and the Sea" has been inscribed on the [UNESCO World Heritage list](#).

The harbour of Rio de Janeiro is comprised of a unique entry from the ocean that makes it appear as the mouth of a river. Additionally, the harbor is surrounded by spectacular geographic features including Sugarloaf mountain at 395 meters (1,296 feet), Corcovado Peak at 704 meters (2,310 feet), and the hills of Tijuca at 1,021 meters (3,350 feet). These features work together to collectively make the harbor one of the [Seven Natural Wonders of the World](http://sevensnaturalwonders.org/) (<http://sevensnaturalwonders.org/>).

Rio de Janeiro hosted many of the 2014 FIFA World Cup games, including the final. It also hosted the 2016 Summer Olympics and Paralympics, becoming the first South American city to host the Summer Olympics.

Districts

Zona Sul

The South Zone is made up of Copacabana, Leblon and Ipanema, as well as the districts along Flamengo Beach. Contains some of the more upscale neighborhoods and many of the major tourist sites, such as the Rodrigo de Freitas Lagoon, and Sugarloaf and Corcovado Mountains.

Centro

Includes Lapa and Santa Teresa. The city's financial and business centre also has many historic buildings from its early days, such as the Municipal Theatre, National Library, National Museum of Fine Arts, Tiradentes Palace, Metropolitan Cathedral and Pedro Ernesto Palace.

Zona Norte

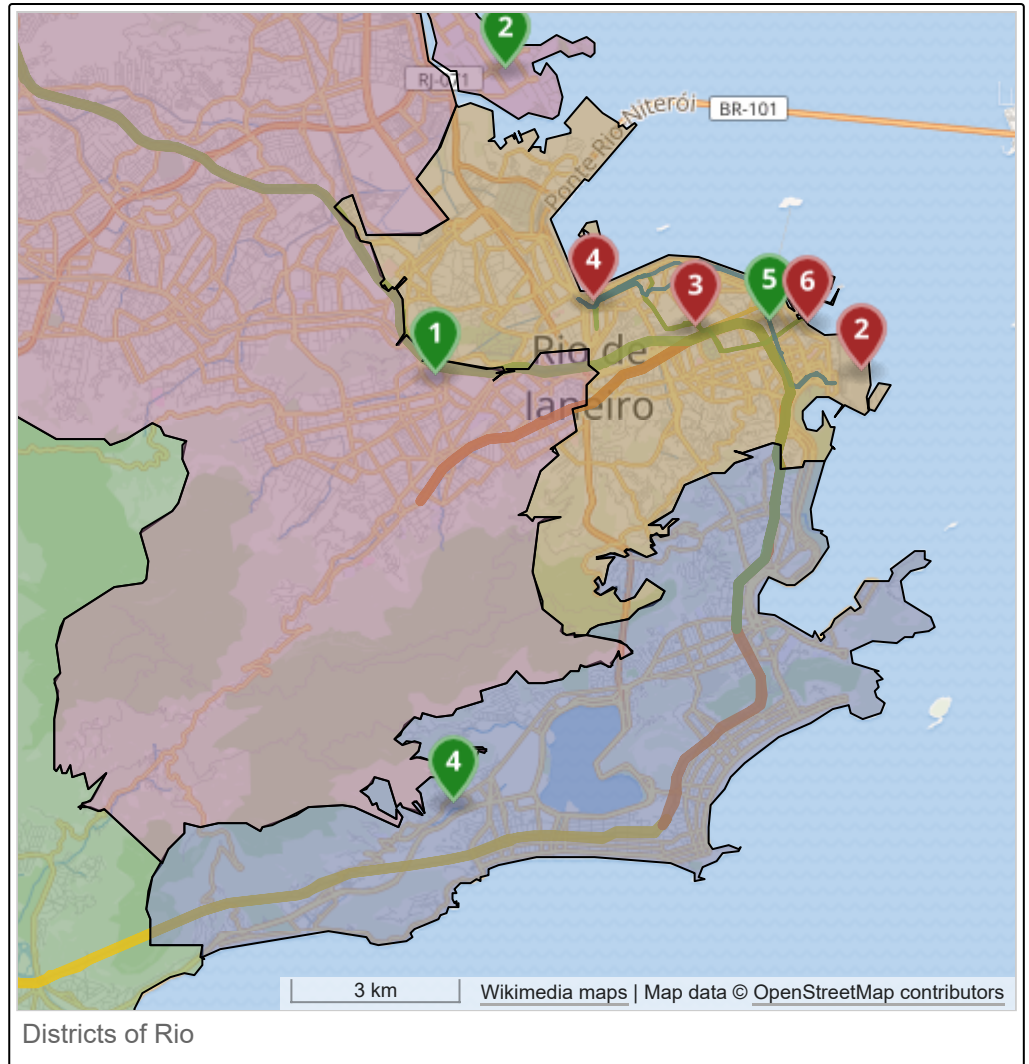
The North Zone includes the Maracanã stadium, Quinta da Boa Vista Park with the city's zoo, the National Observatory and more.

Zona Oeste

The West Zone is a rapidly growing suburban area including primarily the districts of

Jacarepaguá and Barra da Tijuca, popular for its beaches. Most of the Olympics in 2016 were hosted there.

Understand



It is a common mistake to think of **Rio** as Brazil's capital, a distinction it lost on April 21, 1960 when the national government officially moved to Brasília. Beaches such as **Copacabana** and **Ipanema**, the **Christ The Redeemer** (*Cristo Redentor*) statue, the stadium of **Maracanã** and **Sugarloaf Mountain** (*Pão de Açúcar*) are all well-known sights of what the inhabitants call the "marvelous city" (*cidade maravilhosa*), and are also among the first images to pop up in travelers' minds, along with the **Carnaval** celebration.



Sugar Loaf as seen from Corcovado

The South Zone holds most of Rio's landmarks and world-famous beaches, in an area of only 43.87 square kilometres (16.94 sq mi). Many of them are within walking distance of each other (for instance, the Sugarloaf lies about 8 km (5.0 mi) from Copacabana beach). Most hotels and hostels are located in this part of the city, which is compressed between the Tijuca Range (*Maciço da Tijuca*) and the sea. There are important places in other regions as well, such as Maracanã stadium in the North Zone and the many fascinating buildings in the centre.

Sadly, most people also know Rio for its violence and crime, especially related to drugs. And social problems, as slums or *favelas*, areas of poor-quality housing and living; these slums are usually located on the city's many mountain slopes, juxtaposed with middle-class neighbourhoods.

History

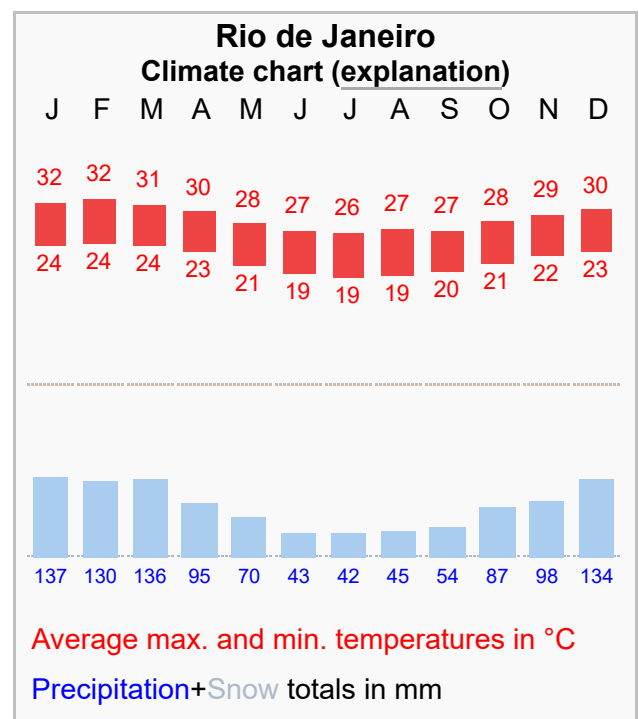
Rio was founded in 1565 by the Portuguese as a fortification against French privateers who trafficked wood and goods from Brazil. Piracy played a major role in the city's history, and there are still colonial fortresses to be visited (check below). The Portuguese fought the French for nearly 10 years, both sides having rival native tribes as allies. For the next two centuries it was an unimportant outpost of the Portuguese Empire, until gold, diamonds, and ore were found in Minas Gerais in 1720. Then, as the nearest port, Rio became the port for these minerals and replaced Salvador as the main city in the colony in 1763. When Napoleon invaded Portugal, the Royal Family moved to Brazil and made Rio capital of the Kingdom (so it was the only city outside Europe to be capital of a European country). When Brazil became independent in 1822, it adopted Monarchy as its form of government (with Emperors Pedro I and Pedro II). Many historians and Brazilians from other places say *cariocas* are nostalgic of the Royal and Imperial times, which is reflected in many place names and shop names. In 2009, the city won their bid to host the games of the XXXI Olympics in the summer of 2016. This was the fifth bid by the city, whose 1936, 1940, 2004, and 2012 bids lost.



Though modest and small, the Paço was the office of the King of Portugal and Brazil's two Emperors. 

Climate

The climate of the city of Rio de Janeiro is tropical with a hot, humid and sometimes rainy summer and a mild and dry winter. In December and January, the heat and humidity are usually constant, reaching up to 45 °C (113 °F). However, it rains less in Rio de Janeiro than in other cities in the Southeast (for example, São Paulo) and the rains are usually sudden and rapid, giving a welcoming relief from the sizzling afternoon temperatures. During winter in the southern hemisphere, temperatures in Rio are usually milder. In these months rainfall decreases, and average temperatures are typically 19 °C (66 °F) to maximums of 26 °C (79 °F).



- [Riotur \(https://riotur.rio/en/welcome/\)](https://riotur.rio/en/welcome/) website

Get in

Rio is one of the country's major transportation hubs, second only to São Paulo.

By plane

Metropolitan area airport code for the two airports of the city is unsurprisingly **RIO** ^{IATA}.

- International and most domestic flights land at **1 Galeão - Antônio Carlos Jobim International Airport (GIG)** ^{IATA} Galeão International Airport), Av. Vinte de Janeiro, s/n° - Galeão, Ilha do Governador (*20 km (12 mi) north from the city centre and main hotels*), ☎ +55 21 3398-5050, fax: +55 21 3393-2288. While you can sometimes zoom through Immigration and Customs, be prepared for a long wait. Brazilians travel with lots of baggage and long queues can form at Customs, which are usually hopelessly understaffed.
- **2 Santos Dumont Airport (http://www.aeroportosantosdumont.net/en/)** (**SDU** ^{IATA}), Praça Senador Salgado Filho, s/n - Centro (*east of the city centre, by the Guanabara bay.*), ☎ +55 21 3814-7070, fax: +55 21 2533-2218. Gets flights only from São Paulo and some of Brazil's largest cities such as Belo Horizonte, Porto Alegre and Salvador, as well as the capital Brasília. Airlines that service Santos Dumont include: GOL (<http://www.voegol.com.br>), LATAM (<https://www.latam.com/>), Azul (<http://viajemais.voeazul.com.br/>) and Avianca (<http://www.avianca.com.br>). Don't rush off without taking a look inside the original terminal building - a fine example of Brazilian modernist architecture.

If the flight connections to Rio don't suit you, you can check flights to the airports of São Paulo, Belo Horizonte, Campinas or Vitoria. From there you can take an intercity bus to Rio.

Public transport from the airports of Rio

From *Galeão (GIG)* two **bus** lines operated by *Real* (<http://www.realautoonibus.com.br/Site/NossasLinhas-Premium-00,undefined,REAL84866120120119115236-71.html>) depart from right outside the arrival section. Buses are air-conditioned and comfy, with ample luggage space. They run roughly every 30 minutes from 5:30AM to 10PM.

- **Bus line 2018 Aeroporto Internacional do RJ/Alvorada (Via Orla da Zona Sul)** runs between both airports, the main bus terminal and further along the beachfront of *Botafogo*, *Copacabana*, *Ipanema* and *Leblon*, and has its terminus at the *Alvorada* terminal near *Barra Shopping* in *Barra da Tijuca*. The full run takes at least 60 minutes, often double that. Tickets are R\$16 (Dec 2016).
- **Bus line 2918 Aeroporto Internacional do RJ/Alvorada (Via Linha Amarela)** runs to the *Alvorada* bus terminal, via *Jacarapaguá* (the best spot for taxis) from *Galeão* airport along the *Linha Amarela* in as little as 35 minutes, traffic allowing.

For a slightly cheaper option, go ahead as follows. **From the airport**, take BRT (Bus Rapid Transport System) (R\$4.70, RioCard needed, but can be used on Metro as well) to *Vicente de Carvalho* and transfer to the metro. The BRT does not go into the center, but north around Rio towards Alvorada Bus Terminal and Terminal Jardim Oceânico. From Alvorada they connect to other BRT to Santa Cruz and Campo Grande west. The BRT also connects to the commuter rail system in Madureira. If you head **to the airport**, you need to take BRT bus #30 *semi direto* to *Galeão*, from *Vicente de Carvalho*. The bus goes every 30 min or so, from the middle doors of

the 100 m long bus stop. Allow 1.5 hr for the trip between center and airport, especially if you do it the first time. Connect to *Vicente de Carvalho* using metro line 2 (R\$4.70). Between metro and BRT at *Vicente de Carvalho*, walk the white footpath. At the airport, you get off at Terminal 2, when all people get off.

Taxis

There are two types of **taxis**. As you leave Customs you will see booths of different companies offering their services. These are considerably more expensive than the standard yellow taxis that are to be found outside the terminal building but the quality of the cars is generally better and the price is pre-set and final and you pay at the booth before going to the car with no need to pay (or tip) the driver. These taxis can often charge double the price of those ordinary taxis from the rank around 100 metres from the arrivals exit. It is possible to reserve airport transfers. Standard yellow taxis are cheaper but usually run on meters meaning that, due to high traffic, you may end up paying more than originally expected. Also, although very rare nowadays, you will need to keep the eye on the road (maybe following your route on Google Maps or similar) to ensure that the driver does not make a (long) diversion running up a high fare at the end. Many will also want payment in cash rather than card.

Money

Money change facilities are limited and high commissions are charged. Slightly better rates can be obtained, illegally, at the taxi booths but they may want you to use their cabs before changing money for you. In any event, don't change more than you have to as much better rates are available downtown. However, if you have a VISA or Mastercard Debit Card, you may use the Airport's ATMs (Banco 24 Horas) which will allow you to withdraw cash for a fee. IN this case, do not accept the suggest exchange rate but ask for it to be debited in Reals in your account since your bank will almost certainly have a better rate to offer.

Destinations

From Europe, LATAM (<https://www.latam.com/>) Airlines offers direct flights from Paris (daily), London and Frankfurt (both three times a week). Air France flies twice a day from Paris, British Airways three times a week from London, TAP twice a day from Lisbon and on Fridays and Sundays to Porto, Lufthansa four days a week from Frankfurt, KLM four days a week from Amsterdam and Iberia daily from Madrid. From Africa, Taag connects Rio to Luanda four times a week, and from Asia, Emirates has a daily non-stop flight to Dubai, where it is possible to continue to many Asian destinations (also, from Rio this flight continues to Buenos Aires).

From North America, there are non-stop flights to Rio de Janeiro from Charlotte, New York City and Miami with either American Airlines or LATAM Airlines, Washington, D.C. and Houston with United Airlines, Dallas with American Airlines, and Atlanta with Delta Air Lines. Travellers from elsewhere in the region have to make a stop in the aforementioned U.S. cities or in São Paulo to get to Rio.

Gol, LATAM (<https://www.latam.com/>), Emirates, Aerolíneas Argentinas and other carriers connect Rio de Janeiro to Argentina (Buenos Aires and Cordoba), Venezuela (Caracas), Paraguay (Asuncion), Uruguay (Montevideo) and Chile (Santiago). Avianca and Copa Airlines connect Rio

with Bogotá, Lima and Panama City, respectively, offering onward connections to Central America or other South American cities. LATAM and Aerolineas Argentinas offer connections from their respective hubs to Australia and New Zealand.

By train

3 Central Train Station (Estação Central do Brasil, former: Estação do Campo, Estação da Corte, Dom Pedro II), Praça Procópio Ferreira - Centro (*You can get there by bus, light rail or subway (subway is better; get off on Central station, hub for lines 1 and 2).* Rio's glorious main station became famous due to a movie with the same name. It's worth a visit just to see it. Serves only local commuter lines (**SuperVia** (<http://www.supervia.com.br>)), so it's unlikely that you'll arrive through here. Five of Rio's eight suburban train lines depart from here: The Deodoro line (platform 2, 23 km (14 mi), journey time of 40 minutes), the Santa Cruz line (platform 6, 55 km (34 mi), journey time of 75 minutes), the Japeri line (platform 8, 62 km (39 mi), journey time of 83 minutes), the Belford Roxo line (platform 11, 28 km (17 mi), journey time of 53 minutes), and the Gramacho/Saracuruna line (platform 12/13, 34 km (21 mi), journey time of 62 minutes). More details can be found in the Get around section of Zona Norte.



Estação Central do Brasil, train station  in the city center that serves neighborhoods of Zona Norte and Zona Oeste, as well as Baixada Fluminense

By bus

- **4 Rodoviária Novo Rio** (<https://rodoviariadorio.com.br>) (*in the North Zone's Santo Cristo neighborhood.*). The long-distance bus depot. Bus companies include **Catarinense** (<https://www.aguiabranca.com.br>), **Penha** (<http://www.nspenha.com.br>), **Cometa** (<http://www.viacaocometa.com.br>), **1001** (<http://www.autoviacao1001.com.br>), and **Agua Branca** (<https://www.aguiabranca.com.br>). Coach buses can get you to the South Zone in about 15 minutes; local buses take a bit longer. *Frescão* air-conditioned coaches can be caught just outside the bus station. The coaches connect the station to the city centre and main hotel areas of Copacabana and Ipanema. The light rail also connects to most of the city centre. (updated Apr 2024 |)
- **5 Rodoviário de Campo Grande Bus station** (Terminal Rodoviário de Campo Grande), Rua Aurélio de Figueiredo, Campo Grande, Zone Norte (*BRT TransOeste terminated here.*). Buses from Duque de Caxias, Nova Iguaçu, Itaguaí, Mangaratiba, Niterói and São Gonçalo cities.

Several companies offer bus passes to Rio from the rest of the country.

The Green Toad Bus (<http://www.greentoadbus.com/en/>) offers bus tickets online for buses from Ilha Grande, Paraty, São Paulo, Florianopolis, Campo Grande, Foz do Iguacu and some other destinations in Brazil. They have bus passes to take you to other countries as well.

By boat

Ferries (*barcas*) connect neighbouring Niterói to Rio de Janeiro and arrive at Praça XV (see down), in the city centre.

By car

Rio is connected by many roads to neighboring cities and states, but access can be confusing as there are insufficient traffic signs or indications of how to get downtown.

The main interstate highways passing through Rio are:

- **BR-116**, which connects the city to the southern region of Brazil. Also known as Rodovia Presidente Dutra
- **BR-101**, which leads to the north, northwest plus Costa Verde (Green Coast - Paraty, Mangaratiba, Angra dos Reis) and São Paulo Coast (Ubatuba, Caraguatatuba, Bertioga, Santos) and beyond towards the South of Brazil, and
- **BR-040**, which will take you in the central and western areas.



Estação Praça XV, ferry station that connects the downtown area to some insular neighborhoods of Rio de Janeiro in the Guanabara Bay, and also to Leste Fluminense

Get around

Rio de Janeiro possesses an extensive and complex, highly multi-modal public transportation system, adapted to the city's unique topography – large areas covered by mountains surrounded by pockets of densely populated flat lands. Among the public transportation modes, there is subway, heavy rail, light rail, bus rapid transit, local buses, microbuses, cable cars and ferry boats.

The city uses a prepaid transport SmartCard, the *RioCard Bilhete Único Carioca*, which costs as much as a single ride (R\$4,70) and gives access to nearly all available public transportation (mostly excluding tourist rides), also offering discounts if the user takes more than one transportation within a 2-hr time period and stays within the Rio de Janeiro municipality. Cards can be returned with getting the money on it back. This can be a good way to get cash off credit cards that have a minimum cash withdrawal of like US\$40, but in case you only need another R\$40 before leaving the country.

Unfortunately, the RioCard cannot be returned at the airport or at most stations. It can only be returned at a RioCard store which only exist in certain major stations.

It is very convenient to get a *Bilhete Único* if you plan to use public transport on a regular basis during your stay in Rio, as it saves you the hassle of constantly figuring out which type of integration ticket to buy. If you stick to subway, heavy rail, bus rapid transit and local buses (not including executive buses), a public transport trip using the *Bilhete Único* shall cost between US\$1–2.

By boat

- Ferry boats depart from **6 Praça XV. Station (<https://barcas.grupoccr.com.br/>)** (Estação das Barcas), Praça Quinze de Novembro. The city ferry network include: Eight stations (Praça XV, Praça Arariboia, Charitas, Paquetá, Cocotá, Ilha Grande, Mangaratiba, Angra dos Reis). - Six lines are: Praça XV - Praça Arariboia (20 min., R\$ 4,80); Praça XV - Charitas (20

min, R\$13); Praça XV - Paqueta (50-70 min, R\$4,80); Praça XV - Cocotá (55 min, R\$4,80); Ilha Grande - Mangaratiba (80 min, R\$14); Ilha Grande - Angra dos Reis (80 min, R\$14)

By light rail/tram

- Santa Teresa Tram, Centro
- Corcovado Rack Railway, Zona Sul
- **VLT (<https://www.vltrio.com.br/>)** ("Veículo Leve sobre Trilhos", Portuguese for "light rail vehicle"). connects Rodoviária Novo Rio, Santos Dumont Airport, Praça XV ferry station, Central do Brasil train station, and a couple of subway stations. Can only be paid with a Bilhete Único card (each person must have a separate card), which can be bought in any stop but not within the vehicle. The ticket must be validated immediately after entering the vehicle, otherwise a R\$170 fine will be levied. R\$4,70. (updated Apr 2025 |)

By cable car

- Sugarloaf Cable Car (Zona Sul)

By bus

Buses are still the cheapest and most convenient way to get around the South Zone (Zona Sul) of the city due to the high number and frequency of lines running through the area. For the adventurous or budget traveller, it is worth asking your hotel or hostel employees how to navigate the system or which routes to take to arrive at specific locations. However, you should be mindful of questionable characters and your belongings. By night buses are more scarce, and most lines will usually not be running by the time the bars and clubs are full. Buses start at R\$4,70; buses with air conditioning charge higher fares. The fare is paid in cash to a controller or the driver inside the bus, by passing through a roulette. There are no tickets, and try to have change/small bills. Some residents and students have a digital pass card. Keep an eye out for pickpockets when the bus is crowded, and don't be surprised if your driver goes a little faster and brakes a little more suddenly than you'd like. Except for minibuses, buses now have two doors: passengers get in through the front door and get off through the back (it was otherwise until 2001–2002).



A Rio city bus

Some bus stops in the South Zone are equipped with a shelter and a bench, but sometimes, far from tourist areas, they are less obvious and have no signs at all - you might have to ask. As a general rule in most parts of Brazil, buses stop only when you hail them, by extending the arm. If you don't hail and there are no passengers waiting to get off, the bus simply won't stop. The same can be said if you are on the bus wanting to get off at a particular stop. You should know the surroundings or the name of the intersection of the area you are going, or inquire to the employee operating the roulette, so you can signal to the driver that you want to get off, or he may not stop! There are no schedules nor timetables, but there is an invaluable book called Ruas de Rio de Janeiro (The streets of Rio de Janeiro) that has maps of Rio and lists bus routes by bus line. Although it does not list the exact schedule of arrivals and departures, it lists the bus stops,

and one can easily orient oneself and navigate the city using it. Usually, buses run no less infrequently than every 15 minutes. However, they can run just once an hour or more infrequently late at night or in remote areas of town.

There are a baffling 1000+ bus lines in Rio (including variants), covering nearly all of the city, operated by perhaps a dozen independent operations. (At least 6 operations ply the streets of Copacabana and Ipanema.) The website (<https://www.vadeonibus.com.br/vdo/>) contains a catalog of the lines and offers the option to plan a bus trip, but little help when offline, a great alternative is the site, The site Bus Schedule (<https://horariodeonibus.net/vadeonibus/>), for offering a catalog with several constantly updated lines. Many lines differ only a few streets from each other in their itineraries, and some even have variants within the same line. Bus lines with a * or a letter mean that this bus has a variant. It means that there may be a bus with the same name, same number, same origin, even the same destination but with a completely different route. Lines are numbered according to the general route they serve:

- beginning with 1 - South Zone/Downtown
- beginning with 2 - North Zone/Downtown
- beginning with 3 - West Zone/Downtown
- beginning with 4 - North Zone/South Zone
- beginning with 5 - within South Zone
- beginning with 6 - North Zone/West Zone
- beginning with 7 and 9 - within North Zone
- beginning with 8 - within West Zone

Most popular lines for tourists are 583 and 584 (from Copacabana and Ipanema to Corcovado railway station), as well as 464 and 435 (from Copacabana to Maracanã). Buses 511 (Ataulfo de Paiva) and 512 (Bartholomeu Mitre) are also popular as they take you to Urca for the station to take the cable car up the Sugarloaf mountain. Typically bus drivers and controllers won't understand any foreign language. If you can't speak Portuguese at all, use a map. Trying to speak Spanish is usually not particularly useful.

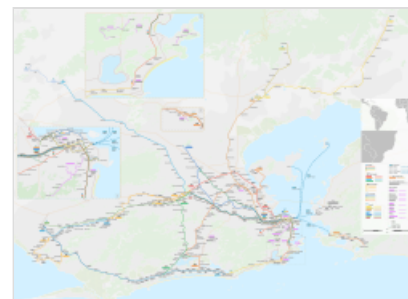
By Bus Rapid Transit (BRT)

The BRT is a mass rapid transit system based on multiple-car buses running on exclusive lanes, inspired by similar systems in Curitiba, Bogota and Jakarta. There are three BRT lines:

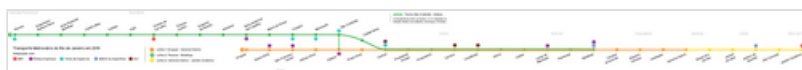
- **TransCarioca:** links the **Galeão - Antônio Carlos Jobim International Airport** to the Barra da Tijuca neighbourhood, also connecting with the Line 2 (Green) subway line that gives access to Zona Sul and the Centro. Useful for visitors who want to go from the Galeão airport to the touristic neighbourhoods (Barra and the beaches of Zona Sul) and are on a tight budget;
- **TransOeste:** links the future Jardim Oceânico subway station (which shall be operating before the 2016 Olympics) to the extreme northwest of the municipality (Santa Cruz and Campo Grande neighbourhoods). Useful for visitors staying in Barra da Tijuca to move around in the area or to go to the Zona Sul or the Centro by connecting to the subway;
- **TransOlímpico:** inaugurated during the 2016 Summer Olympics, it connects the Deodoro neighbourhood in Zona Norte to Barra da Tijuca, passing through several Olympic facilities. Basically useful to visitors to the Olympic events.

By subway

The **Metrô Rio** (<http://www.metrorio.com.br>) subway system is very useful for travel from Jardim Oceânico (in Barra da Tijuca) to Downtown and beyond, passing through the Zona Sul beaches including Leblon, Ipanema and Copacabana (the extension to Leblon and Barra da Tijuca shall be inaugurated before the 2016 Summer Olympics). It closes after midnight (24 hours during Carnaval). The air-conditioned subway is safe, clean, comfortable, and quick, and has much better signage than most transport in Rio, making the lives of foreign tourists easier. There are two main lines: Line **1** has service to Ipanema (General Osorio), the Saara district, and much of Downtown, as well as Tijuca. Line **2** stops at the zoo, Maracanã stadium, and Rio State University. The two lines are integrated between Central and Botafogo, so check the train's destination if you board within the integrated section for a destination in the Zona Norte. A one-way subway-only "unitário" ticket is R\$4,70. The ticket window will give you a card that you insert in the turnstile; do not pull it out unless you've purchased a multi-trip or transfer pass. Rechargeable IC cards (minimum charge R\$5, no deposit required) are also available and definitely worth getting if you'll be in town for a few days.



A detailed map of Greater Rio's urban transport, including subway lines with stations and BRT bus lines



MetrôRio subway network.

The *Metrô* company operates bus lines from some stations to nearby neighborhoods which are not served by the subway system. This is particularly helpful for places uphill such as Gávea, Laranjeiras, Grajaú and Usina. Since the city grew around the Tijuca Range mountains, these neighborhoods will never be served by the subway, but you now can take the *integração* (connection) minibuses. The company calls it *Metrônibus* and *Metrô na Superfície* (literally, *Subway on Ground*), but actually they are ordinary buses in special routes for subway commuters. You can buy tickets for these - just ask for *expresso* (pronounced "eysh-PREH-sso", not "express-o") when buying a ticket, then keep it after crossing the roulette (prices range from R\$ 2.80 to 4.40, depending on the transfer you want, as of Sep 2010). When you leave the subway, give the ticket to the bus driver (who shall be waiting in the bus stop just outside of the station). If you buy an ordinary ticket, you won't be able to get this bus for free - then it will cost a regular fee.

The last car of each train is marked for women-only with a pink window sticker, in order to avoid potential harassment in crowded trains. Some men, however, are not yet used to this separation, and many women, who are accustomed to hassle-free everyday travel in Rio's subway, also think the measure is unnecessary. Anyway, if you're a man, avoid getting into trouble with local security staff and stay off the pink-marked cars. The women-only policy for the wagon is valid only in the rush hour.

By SuperVia suburban trains

Eight lines operating. Five of them from Central station (see above). They can be useful exploring the northern and western suburbs and bairros (quarters).

By taxi

In the areas without subway, trams, SuperVia or BRT (Bus Rapid Transit) use a cab. All legal cabs are yellow with a blue stripe painted on the sides. Taxis not designed like this are special service cars (to the airport or bus stations) or illegal. Rio taxis are not too expensive on a kilometre basis, but distances can be quite considerable. A journey from Zona Sul to the Centro will cost around R\$20, and from the airport to Copacabana is around R\$50 for example. The car can usually hold four people. You can ask a cab for a city tour, and arrange a fixed price (may be around US\$20). Major taxi companies include Central de Taxi, Ouro Taxi and Yellow Taxi.

After getting into the taxi, check to see if the taximeter has been started, it charges R\$5.50 (July 2018) for the minimum ride, called *bandeirada*, and R\$2.50 per kilometer. If not, ask the taxi driver to do so. Some taxi drivers may wish to negotiate a fixed price in lieu of using the taximeter stating that they want to help you out and give you a cheaper fare. This is common for taxi drivers queued at tourist stops such as Pão de Açúcar and may be a confidence trick. Keep in mind that the taximeter may give you a better price. When in doubt, use the taximeter. You are the customer and you are in control. If the taxi driver will not comply, leave the taxi and find another.

You may be ripped off by some taxi drivers. If you have any doubt about drivers being completely honest, consider having your route mapped out on your smart phone with Google Maps and GPS turned on and ready to go before entering the taxi. By doing so, you can see if your taxi driver closely follows this ideal route. Remember that Avenida Atlântica switches traffic directions during the day, so Google Maps might get it wrong during the morning or evening hours on that road.

You may also consider taking a 'radio-taxi', particularly when arriving at the airport. Radio-taxis are usually the blue, green, or white taxis and they do cost a little more than the typical yellow taxi, but offer a fixed rate. To book in advance you can contact Cootramo Radio Taxi via their website <https://www.cootramo.com.br/>, or Rio Airport Transfer (<http://www.rioairporttransfer.com>) (English Speaking) via their website.

For those traveling to Rio for Carnaval it's worth using a company that allows you to book and pay in advance, and to try to pay as much in advance as possible as prices tend to increase a few weeks before Carnaval.

Be aware that traffic jams in Rio can be terrible at times. A taxi ride from Ipanema to the bus terminal for instance can take an hour and a half if you get seriously stuck, so make sure you have margins in case you really can't afford to be late.



SuperVia train network



To get to the Cristo one had to climb hundreds of steps, but it is possible nowadays to use an elevator and escalator

By e-hailing

Rio de Janeiro is covered by some e-hailing services, Uber being the largest of them. Notable e-hailing services in the city, are:

- Uber
- Cabify
- T81 (Brazilian service)
- Easy (Brazilian service)
- TeLevo (Brazilian service)
- 99Taxi

By car

Traffic within some parts of Rio can be daunting, but a car may be the best way to reach distant beaches like Grumari, and that can be an extra adventure. Avoid rush-hour traffic jams in neighborhoods such as Copacabana, Botafogo, Laranjeiras, and Tijuca, where moms line up their cars to pick up their children after school. Buy a map or use Waze or Google Maps (or similar), and have fun.

Rio has an interesting programme of traffic management. Between 7AM and 10AM on weekday mornings the traffic flow of one carriageway on the beachfront roads of Ipanema and Copacabana is reversed, i.e. all traffic on those roads flows in the same direction, towards the city. On Sundays and public holidays the carriageway closest to the beach is closed to allow pedestrians, cyclists, skateboarders, skaters and others to exercise.

Street parking in many parts of Rio is covered by a paid parking regime called Rio Rotativo. Areas subject to the regime are signposted, and in some instances a parking attendant will hand you a ticket which must be displayed on the dashboard. Formal street parking begins at R\$2 per hour, not including the tip to the parking attendant. In other areas, street parking is not subject to Rio Rotativo and parking is free, but in areas where parking is limited like Lapa or the area around Praia Vermelha flanelinhas (informal parking attendants) abound, and if they help you find parking paying what they ask for is largely non-negotiable.

By bicycle

There are Itaú rental bicycle available in Rio: <https://bikeitau.com.br> (bookable by app).

See

Sights

Corcovado, the 710 m (2,330 ft) granite peak located in the Tijuca Forest in central Rio is known worldwide for the Cristo Redentor statue. The funicular train up to Cristo Redentor is definitely worth the view. The queue for the train, in Cosme Velho, can get rather long though. There's also a hiking trail that begins at Parque Lage and gets there (see Hiking and Trekking on the 'Do' section below).

Pão de Açúcar, the Sugarloaf Mountain (one taller, the other shorter), Brazil's top landmark, with a two-stage aerial tramway to the top; a definite must-see. There is also an unsigned trail leading to the second station. Do not make the mistake of thinking you have seen enough once you have seen the view from Cristo Redentor. Try Sugarloaf at sunset for a truly mind-blowing experience.

Lagoa Rodrigo de Freitas is a large lagoon in the middle of South Zone, with great views to Corcovado and Ipanema and Leblon beaches; you can jog or cycle all the way round; there are skating areas and you can hire little pedal-operated boats.

Maracanã the largest football stadium in South America and once the largest on Earth. It is in a state of disrepair following the Summer 2016 Olympics, and daily tours have been suspended. There is also a Soccer Museum inside it.

Streetcar of Santa Teresa, Brazil's only remaining metropolitan heritage streetcar.

Jardim Botânico, the Botanical Garden, planted in the 1800s. It is both a park and a scientific laboratory contains a huge collection of plants from all over the world, not only tropical ones.

Parque Lage a small park containing some interesting plants and wildlife as well as strange concrete structures that will entertain the kids. The park is the beginning of a hiking trail Corcovado, through sub-tropical rain forest.

Parque do Flamengo, also known as Aterro do Flamengo is along the bay between Flamengo and Glória. 1.2 million square metres with broad walkways, Flamengo Beach, various monuments, and over 10,000 trees.



Copacabana sidewalk



Across Guanabara Bay, one of Rio's best views (one that includes both the Christ and the Sugarloaf in your camera frame) can be seen from this Museum in Niterói, only 20 minutes away from downtown Rio by ferry boat

Buildings

- **Paço Imperial** is the former imperial palace (though impressively modest), colonial architecture, in downtown, next to *aça XV*.
- **Casa França Brasil** (1820) is the French cultural centre, with gallery and video hall (in downtown, next to CCBB).
- **Centro Cultural Banco do Brasil (CCBB)** (1906) is a cultural centre with gallery, movie theater, video room, library and stages; usually hosts the main exhibitions in town (in downtown). An interesting building with old-fashioned elevators/lifts.



The Maracanã stadium, once the largest on Earth

- Candelária Church is a neoclassic cathedral next to CCBB in downtown.
- Mosteiro de São Bento (*Saint Benedict's Monastery*, 1663) is colonial architecture in downtown.
- **Ilha Fiscal Palace** (1889) - Located in the Guanabara Bay, next to the Navy Museum
- **Gloria Church** (1739). Small but interesting church reached by a funicular. Nice views. (metro: Gloria)
- **Palácio Gustavo Capanema** - Former ministry of culture, designed by Brazilian architects: Oscar Niemeyer, Lúcio Costa, Carlos Leão, Ernâni Vasconcelos, Affonso Eduardo Reidy, Jorge Machado Moreira, with the consulting of Le Corbusier; though small, it is regarded as an important pioneering in modern architecture (downtown).
- **Arcos da Lapa** (1750) - Lapa Aqueduct, colonial structure that brought water from springs to downtown.
- **Catedral Metropolitana** - a modern, cone-shaped cathedral, designed by Edgar de Oliveira da Fonseca (in Lapa).
- **São Francisco da Penitência church** (1773) - Colonial church.
- **Teatro Municipal** (1909) - City Theater, inspired by the Paris Opéra House (in Cinelândia square).
- **Biblioteca Nacional** (1910) - *National Library* (in Cinelândia square).
- **Câmara Municipal** - The City Hall, hosts the city council (in Cinelândia square).
- **Palácio do Catete** - The former presidential palace (1893-1960), now hosts a museum of recent history and nice gardens (in Catete).
- **Itamaraty** - Former presidential palace (1889-1893) and foreign office; now hosts a museum of South American diplomacy, a library and the UN information offices in Brazil (in Downtown, next to the Central station).
- **Palácio Guanabara** - Former palace of the Imperial Princess, now governor's office; eclectic architecture; not open to public (in Laranjeiras).
- **Art Deco**. Rio is a major centre for the Art Deco style of architecture. Indeed, the statue of Christ the Redeemer on Corcovado is considered a classic example of Art Deco work. There are numerous buildings in Copacabana and elsewhere that employ this style.



Quinta da Boa Vista, a park where Rio's Zoo is located. 

Museums

There is no shortage of things to do on a rainy day. In addition to a wide range of museums, Rio has many cultural centres, which are run by banks and other organizations and usually host free exhibitions. Details of what is on can be found in the "Segundo Caderno" section of the daily *O Globo* newspaper, which provides more detail in a weekly Friday supplement. Also very useful is the *Mapa das Artes Rio de Janeiro*, which provides detailed bi-monthly listings as well as detailed maps of the city. This is free and can be picked up at most museums.

Downtown you can find a number of museums. Museu Histórico Nacional covers Brazilian history stretching from colonial to imperial times with a big collection of paintings and artifacts. The Museu Nacional de Belas Artes, Museum of Fine Arts in Cinelândia square includes large paintings from Academicist and Neoclassical Brazilian artists, as well as many copies of European sculptures. The second most important contemporary art museum in Brazil, after MASP is the MAM - Museu de Arte Moderna.

The Museu da Imagem e do Som (Image and Sound Museum) is the place to go for researchers about Brazilian film, radio, and broadcasting industry. Also downtown check out the Navy Museum or the Museu Chácara do Céu an important collection of South American modern art in Santa Tereza).



Aerial view of downtown Rio and surroundings where most historic buildings and museums can be found

In the south zone, hosted in the former presidential Catete palace is the Museu da República, this museum hosts permanent exhibitions about recent Brazilian history (from 1889 on); one of main features is the room where president Getúlio Vargas shot himself in 1954.

Also in Catete, Oi Futuro hosts a fine gallery with temporary exhibitions of digital art or art with interactive medias. Museu Carmen Miranda about this Brazilian actress and singer (the lady with pineapples-and-bananas hat), the national icon in the 1940s and 50s is in Flamengo.

Museu do Índio is a small museum in Botafogo with a collection of Brazilian Indian (*povos indígenas*) photographs, paintings, artifacts and other craft. Very popular with local schoolchildren, but has much for adults as well. Museu Villa-Lobos is a modest collection about Brazil's most important composer.

In the North Zone, Museu de Astronomia e Ciências Afins the Astronomy Museum in São Cristóvão has an observatory. Museu do Trem is a modest collection of 19th century engines, train cars and streetcars in Engenho de Dentro.

In the West Zone, Museu Casa do Pontal is an important collection of popular arts and crafts can be found in Recreio dos Bandeirantes. Museu Aeroespacial an Aerospace Museum in Campo dos Afonsos.

Do

Carnaval

Still the greatest reason for visiting Rio seems to be the **Carnaval**. This highly advertised party lasts for almost two weeks and it is well known for the *escolas de samba* (samba schools) that parade in Centro, on a gigantic structure called *Sambódromo* (Sambadrome). During Carnaval, Rio has much more to offer though, with the *blocos de rua*, that parade on the streets. There are now hundreds of these street "samba blocks", that parade almost in every neighborhood, especially in Centro and the South Zone, gathering thousands of people. Some are very famous, and there are few *cariocas* that have not heard of "Carmelitas", "Suvaco de Cristo", "Escravos da Mauá" or "Simpatia É Quase Amor".

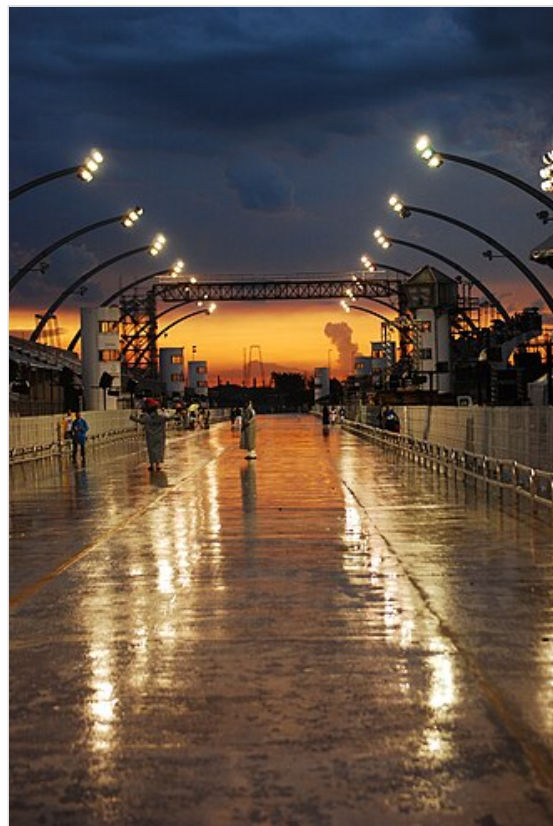
The rest of the year, samba shows are popular with tourists, and are held at several venues like *Plataforma* and *Scala*. These are expensive and not really representative of Brazilian culture, they present a lot of almost naked women and bad musicians, a tourist trap (much like the real thing.) Much more interesting and genuine, though, are the night practice sessions held by the various samba schools in the months leading up to Carnaval. You will find only a small number

of tourists here, and you will be served the best caipirinhas of your trip! These go on into the wee hours of the morning, with the fun really only starting at 01:00-02:00. A good cab driver should be able to hook you up, and cabs will be available to take you back when you are samba-ed out. Salgueiro and Mangueira are good choices, as they are two of the larger samba schools, and are located relatively close to the tourist areas in a fairly safe area.

A change is afoot that may make this genuine experience a thing of the past (or more convenient, depending on your viewpoint) for all but the most savvy tourists. The local government built a complex of buildings, the **Cidade do Samba**, where many of the samba schools moved their practice halls and float-construction facilities from the gritty warehouses typically located in or near their home favelas. One can expect many more tourists, and shows made-up for the tourists as the tourist bureau milks this facility for all it's worth year-round.

Here is a list of some of the samba schools:

- **Mangueira** (<http://www.mangueira.com.br>), Rua Visconde de Niterói, 1072, Mangueira, ☎ +55 21 3872-6786, fax: +55 21 2567-4637, epm@mangueira.com.br (mailto:epm@mangueira.com.br). Rehearsals every Saturday, 22:00.
- **Salgueiro** (<http://www.salgueiro.com.br>), Rua Silva Teles, 104, Andaraí, ☎ +55 21 2238-9258, secretaria@salgueiro.com.br (mailto:secretaria@salgueiro.com.br). Rehearsals every Wednesday, 20:00.
- **Acadêmicos da Rocinha** (<https://www.facebook.com/gresrocinha/>).



Sambodrome at night, where thousands spend the night dancing, singing and celebrating their favorite samba school (comparable to soccer teams) till dawn

Music

Rio was the cradle of three of Brazil's most important musical genres: samba, choro, and bossa nova. There has been a boom of traditional samba and choro venues. A lot of them are in the downtown district of Lapa. There are good and cheap nightlife options, where you will see some of the best musicians of the country. Any of the city newspapers provide pointers to the best shows.

If you're not such an anthropological type of tourist, you can check out the same papers for tips on other kinds of music. Being a big city, Rio has big and small clubs that play almost every kind of music. The major mainstream clubs mostly play whatever's on the Radio - which is usually whatever's on the USA radios and MTV - but the underground scene has a lot to offer on Rock, EDM, Rap and such. The best way to find out about those are the flyers handed or left at hostels, cinema and theater lobbies, nightclub lines, etc.

New Year's Eve celebrations

Rio hosts the country's largest and most popular New Year's Eve celebrations. The huge fireworks display and music shows attract 2 million people to the sands of Copacabana beach every year. People dress in white for luck and toast the arrival of the new year. It's usual also to have some national and international concerts on the beach for free.

Beaches

Ramos Beach is the only one in Zona Norte, but it is inappropriate for bathing.

Zona Sul and Zona Oeste have a wide range of beaches. See the district articles for details. The only official nudist beach is Praia do Abricó, located there. It is also worth visiting the beaches in Paquetá, particularly, Praia da Moreninha.

Cariocas have a unique **beach culture**, with a code of customs which foreigners (and Brazilians from other cities) can misconstrue easily. Women may wear tiny string bikinis, but that does not mean they are trying to attract a man. Until the 1990s, men and boys wore *speedos*, but since then wearing Bermuda shorts or boardshorts has become more common, although *speedos* (*sungas* in Portuguese) seem to now be making a comeback. Jammers are less common but still accepted.

Waves in Rio vary from tiny and calm in the Guanabara bay beaches to high, surf-ideal waves in Recreio. In Leme, Copacabana, Arpoador, Ipanema, and Leblon, there's a popular way of "riding" the waves called *pegar jacaré* (pe-GAHR zha-kah-REH; literally, "to grab an alligator"). You wait for the wave to come behind you then swim on top of it until it crumbles next to the sand.

Commerce is common in Rio's beaches, with thousands of walking vendors selling everything from sun glasses to fried shrimp to cooling beverages (try *mate com limão*, a local ice tea mixed with lemonade, or *suco de laranja com cenoura*, orange and carrot juice). For food, there is also *empada* (baked flour pastry filled with meat or cheese) and *sanduíche natural* (cool sandwich with vegetables and mayo). Vendors typically shout out loud what they're selling. Vendors may approach you unsolicited and be unrelenting when trying to sell something. This is especially true for Copacabana Beach. All along the beaches there are also permanent vendors who will sell you a beer and also rent you a beach chair and an umbrella for a few Reais.

Hang gliding and paragliding

Hang gliding and paragliding flights in Rio de Janeiro take advantage of its high hills and favorable wind. In Rio, the sport can be done in urban areas and landing on the beach! These conditions naturally attract many tourists who get the courage to enjoy a flight. Unless you know what you are doing, make sure to find a business that takes safety seriously.

Hiking and trekking

A huge city that has a forest within its limits has lots to offer for hikers. It's always advisable to have a local with you when trekking in Rio (Couchsurfing's Rio de Janeiro group (<https://www.couchsurfing.com/events/50-cs-group-on-line-meetings-mondays>) usually organizes hikes

around the city), as some treks are not very well-marked. Since the early 2000s, there haven't been any reports of violence/burglary on the city's trails (a problem in the 1990s), but the rules in the [#Stay safe](#) section apply as anywhere else in the city. Some of Rio's hiking trails include:

- **Parque Lage - Corcovado:** The trek is fairly demanding and steep, and takes about 1½–2 hr to complete, but yet very popular among locals; it's normal to see whole families doing it, as well as groups of friends and foreigners. Buy the "Metrô + Metrô Na Superfície" ticket and go to *Botafogo*. From there, take the metrô bus to the station *Hospital da Lagoa*, which is close to the *Parque Lage*. Ask the park's staff or look for signs that say "Trilha" to get to the start of the trail, just behind the ruins of an old house. From there you have two paths: going straight ahead leads to a waterfall that is usually full of families on the weekends (it's a good spot to stop on your way back if you go back the same way), and left leads straight to the main path of the trek. Along the way there are 3 waterfalls (just one you can actually bath in, though) and a small path where you have to hang on to a chain to pass through some rocks. Until this point you will be going up, but always surrounded by forest. The first views of the city will start after the chain (1-1½ hr). Then you get to the train tracks, either follow the rail tracks or the road up to the Christ (another 15 minutes). Views from here on are breathtaking. To go back down, you can get a van or walk about half a mile down to the parking place.
- **Sugarloaf:** This is a short and fairly easy hike, taking 20-30 min to complete, also very popular among locals, specially because you can go up for free then hitch a ride back on the cable car (after 19:00, it's free to return on it). The hike begins at Pista Cláudio Coutinho in Urca, and is very popular among the locals. If you ask the guards they'll point you to the start. It's uphill, but just the first five minutes are really steep and will need you to use your hands. From there on just keep to your left. There are amazing views of Urca and the Guanabara Bay during the final 20 minutes, some of which are angles you don't get from the vantage points above. The trek ends on top of Morro da Urca, the smallest of the two.

Favela (Shantytown) tours

A number of operators offer tours of Rocinha, the largest and safest Favela in Rio. Many tours are done by outside companies in safari-like buses, which can lead to awkward interactions with the locals. Try to go with someone who lives in Rocinha on a walking tour. It is also possible to arrange tours to other favelas, although Rocinha has a longer history of tourism and is one of the more developed favelas.



Rocinha at night



You may hear stories about people being invited by locals to visit their home in a favela. If you receive such an invitation do think carefully about it and perhaps ask around about the person that has invited you. Many of the favelas are rife with drugs and guns so think carefully about how much you trust the person that is inviting you. A search on the Internet may reveal some accounts of tours others have taken. A visit like this will obviously be more authentic than a book tour and could be the highlight of your visit to Rio; on the other hand you are taking a risk. Also consider that favelas are normal neighbourhoods in Rio and not a zoo.

LGBT travel

Rio de Janeiro is the main destination for lesbian and gay travellers from all over Brazil and the rest of the world. The city has been chosen as the best lesbian and gay international destination in 2009, and the sexiest gay place in the world in 2010 and 2011.

Out of town trips

- **Paqueta** — Though not exactly outside of Rio, because it is an island and can only be reached by a 70 minutes ferry ride, this district of Rio makes an excellent (and inexpensive) day trip. The island is a car-free zone, so travel is limited to bicycles and electric golf carts. There's not a lot to do on this island, but the ferry ride is worth it.

Learn

For tourists there are many interesting things to learn. **Samba** (the national rhythm) classes or **capoeira**, a mix of dance and fighting created by the then enslaved African community, are not as hard as outsiders may think, and it's original and fun.

If you are staying in Brazil for an extended time, major universities offer Portuguese courses for foreigners, usually for a very low price and with high educational standards.

- **1 Universidade do Estado do Rio de Janeiro (<http://www.uerj.br>)**.
- **2 Universidade Federal do Rio de Janeiro (<http://www.ufrj.br>)**. (UFRJ) — Offers courses at various levels in Portuguese for foreigners.
- **3 Universidade Federal Fluminense (<http://www.uff.br>)**. located in Niterói
- **4 Pontificia Universidade Católica do Rio de Janeiro (<http://www.puc-rio.br>)**. (PUC-Rio) — Its courses Portuguese for foreigners are popular, but a bit pricey for the beginner's levels.
- **Goethe-Institut (<http://www.goethe.de/br/rio>)**.
- **5 Instituto Brasil-Estados Unidos (<http://www.ibeu.org.br/>)**.
- **Cultura Inglesa (<http://www.culturainglesa.com.br>)**.
- **Instituto Cervantes (<http://riodejaneiro.cervantes.es/br/>)**
- **Aliança Francesa (<http://www.rioaliancafrancesa.com.br>)**
- **Instituto Nacional de Matemática Pura e Aplicada (<http://www.impa.br>)** (IMPA) — the National Institute for Pure and Applied Mathematics. A centre with an international renowned for scientific excellence and superb working conditions in mathematics. You can take any course for free. The summer courses (Jan-Feb) are very popular and there is even the possibility of getting some modest funding for the summer.

Buy

When shopping in street commerce, always bargain; this can lower prices considerably. Bargaining in stores and malls, though, is not welcome. But naturally merchants won't bargain unless you ask, especially if you are clearly a tourist. To tourists, items can easily be overpriced by a factor of 20% especially in highly informal markets such as Saara or on the beach.

For trinkets, your best bet is the "hippie fair" in Praça General Osório in Ipanema every Sunday.

Great bargains can be had on Brazilian-made clothing, as well as some European imports. Most imported items, however, such as electronics, tend to be insanely expensive due to protective import duties. For example, you will find digital cameras sell for about twice what they sell for in Europe or the U.S.

Store managers in Rio often speak some English, as this gains employees an almost-automatic promotion. But "some" can be very little, so it is useful to learn at least some very basic Portuguese. Just knowing basic greetings, numbers, and how to ask directions and prices will get you at least a "B" for effort, and despite finding that store clerks may know more English than you Portuguese, it can still come in handy to know a bit of the language. Don't be afraid to resort to writing numbers, pictures, or resorting to pantomime. Shop assistants will often tap out prices for you on a calculator. Visa and MasterCard are widely accepted in Brazil, with American Express to a slightly lower degree but this have been improving.



Colonial buildings next to modern skyscraper around the Largo da Carioca, in downtown Rio

A great choice of gift, since they do not take much space in the suitcase back home, are bikinis, a trademark from Rio for its quality and fashion style.

Shopping malls can be found all over town, with the cheaper ones in the Zona Norte like Shopping Tijuca and Shopping Iguatemi and popular upscale shopping malls concentrated in the Zona Sul like Shopping Rio Sul and Shopping Leblon and São Conrado Fashion Mall and BarraShopping in Zona Oeste.

Organic food: Organic food arrived in the Brazilian supermarkets but if you want to support local small scale farmers you might consider the following fairs of Circuito Feiras Organicas Carioca (<https://www.facebook.com/feirasorganicas/>):

- Tuesday: Ipanema, Praça Nossa Senhora da Paz, from 07:00 to 13:00
- Thursday:
 - Tijuca, Praça Afonso Pena, from 07:00 to 13:00
 - Leblon, Praça Antero de Quental, from 07:00 to 13:00
- Saturday: Bairro Peixoto, Praça Edmundo Bittencourt, from 08:00 to 13:00
 - Glória, Rua do Russel, from 07:00 to 13:00
 - Jardim Botânico, Praça da Igreja São José da Lagoa, from 07:00 to 13:00

Eat

In Rio de Janeiro you can probably find something to fit any craving. A good approach to local food is "comida a kilo" – buffet style restaurants where you pay by the weight of the food on your plate.

Don't miss the most famous Brazilian dish, **feijoada** (fay-zho-AH-da), a black bean stew filled with big chunks of meat, like sausage, pork and beef. Along with the "feijoada", you also get some colorful side dishes that come with it, such as rice, cassava (roasted manioc), collard greens, fried

pork rinds, and some orange slices, to sweeten things up a bit. This is bonafide, authentic *carioca* culinary excellence, almost worth the trip alone! Best while sipping down a "caipirinha".

For the hungry, nothing beats a good *rodízio* (all-you-can-eat service). These are available in numerous types, although the most well-known are the *churrascaria*, all-you-can-eat grilled meats. At various restaurants around town, you can also find *rodízio* style dining featuring seafood, pizza, or various appetizer-style snacks. The defining element of *rodízio* is that unlike an all-you-can-eat buffet, the servers continuously bring skewers of various meats.

If you like meat but want an alternative to the *rodízios*, a good place to eat at is **Filé de Ouro** (Rua Jardim Botânico, 731, Jardim Botânico; ☎ +55 21 2259-2396; see Google Maps for directions). The place is simple and cozy. During the weekends there are usually big lines, but the steak is delicious. Try "Filé à Oswaldo Aranha", with toasted garlic.

Brazil has the largest population of Japanese outside of Japan, and sushi has become widely popular in Rio too. If you are a sashimi and sushi lover, you will find a great deal of options in Rio de Janeiro.

As a former ex Portugal colony, Brasil has maintained many influences of this country on its culinary. Therefore, you will find great authentic Portuguese restaurants in Rio.

Because its huge coast, many Brazilian specialties are in the seafood area. They are very rich in shrimps, lobster, calamaris, shellfish, clams, mollusks and many other tasty fishes. So, once in this land, don't miss the opportunity to order those lovely dishes.

Travellers with fatter pockets may also splash out a bit at the Dias Ferreira street in Leblon, Rio's up-and-coming restaurant row.

There are many places to get pizza and lots of restaurants also offer pasta.

Rio is also famous for its pastries and street food, heritage from Portuguese and old European culture. In most cafeterias (*lanchonete*; lun-sho-NETCH) you can have a *pastel* (pahs-TELL) or *salgado* (saw-GAH-do; local pastry). Typical pastries are *coxinha* (ko-SHEEN-ya; chicken nugget shaped like a chicken leg), and unique Rio's *joelho* (zho-EH-lyo; rolled dough filled with ham and cheese). Also try *pão de queijo* (pawn-deh-KAY-zho; cheese baked dough), typical from Minas Gerais but very common in Rio as well, and *tapioca* (typical from Bahia), a kind of crepe made out of manioc flour.

For drinking, ask for *guaraná* (gwa-ra-NAH; soda made from the seed of an Amazon fruit, also available as a strong drink), *mate* (MAHTCH; sweet ice tea; not like Rio Grande do Sul's or Argentina's hot and sour *mate*), *água de coco* (ah-gwa-djee-KOH-ku; natural coconut water) or



Feijoada with rice, fried kale, cassava crisps (biscoito de polvilho), cassava flour, and vinagrete (Brazilian tomato slaw)

caldo de cana (caw-do-djee-KAH-na; sugarcane juice). There is also a common fruit called *açaí* (ah-sah-EEH), with a dark-purple pulp out of which are made juices, and ice-creams. Typical cariocas eat it like cream in cups or glasses, mixed with *granola*, oats or other flakes. The best place for such drinks are one of a number of Rio's open juice bars. Very often, these are located on street corners and have long, curved bars offering you juices from pretty much every fruit you can imagine. The best option is a small chain of juice bars called "**Big Bi's**". The juices are astounding value alongside their good selection of *salgados* and sandwiches. Their *açaí* is one of the best in terms of value and taste and the staff are excellent. On top of all this, if you leave a tip, you get a big *obrigado* from all the staff. For the best Big Bi's experience, try the Tangerina ao Limão juice along with the famous Bauru sandwich. Finish it all off with an *açaí* to go. Perfect. Big Bi's has a few branches dotted around Copacabana and Ipanema, one of which is on the corner of Rua Santa Clara and Rua Barata Ribeiro in Copacabana. If you then cross the road of Rua Barata Ribeiro, you will land at an exquisite ice cream parlour.

There are many specialized "health food" shops that offer an incredible variety of rich meat and vegetable sandwiches, plus an awesome variety of fruit juices, many of them delicious and usually unknown by foreigners. Among them are graviola, fruta do conde, jaca, *açaí*, guaraná, pitomba, mango, coconut, orange, lemon, papaya, melon, etc. (they make it as you ask and all food is 100% organic and fresh. The meal is often prepared as you wait, so you can ask them to mix whatever fruit you want and create a customized mix if you like). You must try *açaí* and guaraná, Amazon fruits which are famous to be the strongest energizers and anti-oxidants of the world. They also offer Brazilian snacks (including many Italian and Oriental delicacies), and other simple but delicious things to eat. These shops are usually cheap and hang many fruits at the entrance or somewhere visible to display their quality.

Warning: look for clean places, as hygiene can be poor in many street shops.

If your palate is homesick for more familiar tastes, Rio has most of the fast-food chains found around the world (McDonald's, KFC, Domino's, Outback, Subway, Pizza Hut and Burger King). Bob's and Habib's are the biggest national fast food chains.

Many foods that in other countries are simply picked up in the hands and eaten, are either eaten with knife and fork (such as pizza) or are picked up by wrapping a napkin around the food so that it is not touched with the hands (such as sandwiches). You will undoubtedly notice napkin dispensers on the tables in most restaurants for this purpose.

Drink

What

- **Botequim** (pronounced 'boo-chi-KEEN') also well known as boteco. These unpretentious bars with simple appetizers and lots of ice-cold *chope* (draft beer) are everywhere and are almost inseparable from the *carioca* lifestyle. Try Bracarense (85, José Linhares street, Leblon), one of the most traditional.
- **Juice bars** - Of particular note for an often hot and muggy city are the refreshing juice bars, found on nearly every corner in the city. Choose from dozens of freshly squeezed fruit juices - mix two or three fruits together or simply try the freshly squeezed orange juice. For a

delicious Brazilian special try the *açaí*, a smoothie made from a deep purple fruit from the Amazon.

- **Caipirinha**, a drink made of cachaça (a Brazilian liquor made of sugarcane juice), lime, sugar and ice cubes.



Boteco Salvação, a typical boteco on Rua Henrique de Novaes, Botafogo

Where

- **Kiosks** along the boardwalk at Copacabana and Ipanema beach stay open all night.
- **Devassa**, which has nine locations in Rio, serves well-crafted microbrews, a tropical take of English ale styles.

Neighborhoods:

- Lapa - A good bet for Thursdays, several bars and clubs, but the party is in the street. There you will find people dancing and playing Samba, Choro (soft rhythm with flutes and mandolin), Reggae and Hip Hop, as well as ballroom dancing (*gafieira*), but no Rock (except for some underground, which doesn't happen often or in the same place, but usually in some less known places of Lapa) or Pop music. While drinks are sold in the bars and clubs, vendors also roam the streets wearing coolers full of beer for even cheaper prices. It can also be a very exciting and packed place on Friday and Saturday nights. Be sure not to bring valuables, as there are a lot of pick-pockets operating in the area. Don't take it for the neighborhood with the same name in São Paulo, which is totally different.

Samba clubs

Being in Rio and not going to one of the countless samba live music bars, certainly you've missed a lot on your trip. In Lapa, the nightlife district of Rio, there are many nice bars with great atmosphere where locals go for dancing and meeting people. There are a couple of them in the Zona Sul as well. Most of these bars work with a kind of consumption card, which is handed to you when you enter. Everything you consume is marked on this card, and losing it means you'll have to pay a really high fee! So take good care of it.

Clubbing

For those who like to go clubbing, Rio has some good options. You'll be seeing lots of flyers and talk about "raves" Usually Rio's raves are devoted to trance, which is pretty popular, especially with the upper-class youngsters, though some electronic parties do have good djs and live acts from around the world. The night in Rio is pretty much divided between mainstream and underground.

Mainstream would be such "raves" and big electronic festivals, as well a nightclubs like Zax Club (Barra da Tijuca), Baronetti (Ipanema) and Boate Praia (Lagoa) that are devoted to pop, dance and variations of house and trance. Those are not, however, places you go for the music. They are usually packed with "patricinhas" (tanned, long soft-haired girls with gym-built bodies) and specially "pitboys" (upper/middle-class boys, known for having various degrees of martial arts training and a certain tendency for violence). Yes, fights are one of the major problems with the mainstream clubbing scene in Rio. It's also fairly expensive.

Though with far less options, the underground clubbing scene is more available and interesting than the mainstream. Most of the underground clubs are on Zona Sul and offer different parties for each day of the week. The underground club scene has a more diverse public, from goths to punks also with strong hedonistic tints. It's very gay-friendly and most of the parties and clubs have almost the same m/f proportion. It is also far cheaper than the mainstream clubs. Some good alternative clubs are FosfoBox (Copacabana), Dama de Ferro (Ipanema) and Casa da Matriz (Botafogo).

For a real "carioca" experience, try Mariuzinn Copacabana. Brazilian Funk and electronic music, with an eccentric crowd. It just finishes when the last dancer gives up. Which means early in the morning. It will be an unforgettable experience.

Sleep

In the **Zona Sul**, you will find Rio's fanciest and most popular hotels along the beaches of Ipanema and Copacabana, but there are lots of small, cheap, clean hotels around Flamengo and Catete. The street in front of the strip of tourist hotels in Copacabana can be seedy, due to both garishly-dressed tourists, and a few opportunistic locals ready to take advantage of them. The apart-hotels in Ipanema are a much more pleasant alternative, being both better appointed and in a nicer neighborhood with fewer tourists.



Sunset at Arpoador, best in Rio



Accommodation in the lower **Centro** can be convenient for business travellers. The surrounding areas, however, are far from pleasant at night, being nearly deserted and lacking decent restaurants and leisure options. The central **Santa Teresa** neighbourhood, however, is quite departed from the city centre life and has plenty of pleasant bed and breakfasts and a significant nightlife.

Given Rio's rise as a fashionable destination with creative and fashion people, some hotels that cater to the **design-conscious** crowd have also been popping up at the most upscale neighborhoods. The city also has a large selection of **apart-hotels**, which provide apartment-style accommodations with kitchen facilities. Private condominium **apartments** can also be rented short-term at reasonable rates, and can be found on the internet. This is probably a preferable means of finding one of these than the notes that will be passed to you by anonymous persons on the street. These apartments generally have a one-week minimum, or two weeks during Carnival or New Years holidays.

Accommodation in Rio is probably **Brazil's most expensive**. There is a relative shortage of hotel rooms on the cheaper range and booking in advance is recommended. Moreover, prices for most accommodation can more than triple during New Year's and Carnival. Those are very busy periods and booking *well* in advance is recommended. Most hotels in tourist areas will only sell 4-day packages and charge in advance - even if you want to stay only for a couple of days during those events. Other than those, the busiest month is January - summer holidays in Brazil.

Motels, that you will see mainly on the outskirts of the city, are not motels in the North American sense. Rather, they are places you go with your lover for a few hours. One famous motel, overlooking the Sheraton in Leblon, was taken over by the US Secret Service when George Bush Sr stayed at the Sheraton. It is not recorded whether heart-shaped beds, mirrors on the ceiling and on-tap porno movies affected their work!

If **hostel** life is more your style, they are easy to find in Rio. The more expensive ones boast locations that are short walking distance to either Ipanema or Copacabana beach. However, if you prefer to stay in Lapa, Glória, Catete, and Botafogo, there are many other choices available. Hostelling has become increasingly popular in Brazil, and many of them are located at walking distance from hot spots. Beware, however, not to be taken to any fraudulent scheme - you might end up being robbed. Look for accredited places with Youth Hostelling International and similar franchises.

To experience Rio from another point of view, there's also the opportunity to stay in various hostels in one of the favelas. Due to presence of many police units (called Unidade de Polícia Pacificadora, UPP), it is reasonably safe to stay in some favelas. Ask your hosts about the actual situation, though. See for example Zona Norte for a stay in the *Complexo do Alemão*.

Stay healthy

Rio is vulnerable to epidemics of dengue fever, particularly during the late summer months of February and March. If an epidemic occurs, be sure to take the appropriate precautions by using insect repellent and, if you happen to be staying at a place with a balcony, make sure there is no standing water around.

As elsewhere in Brazil, some beaches in Rio are not suitable for bathing, and conditions can change from day to day. On the day of your visit, check the latest weekly bathing bulletin (<http://www.inea.rj.gov.br/ar-agua-e-solo/balneabilidade-das-praias/>) (in Portuguese, *boletim de balneabilidade*) of the state's Environment Department (INEA). At the bottom of the page, there is a large ad for a mobile app called *Partiu Praia Inea* that provides you an up-to-date map of bathing conditions.

Use sunscreen, especially in your face and shoulders, to avoid having a bad experience with sunburns. Any common drug store sells a variety of sunscreen products, and even cocoa butter lip sticks, to avoid having little cuts after dry lips.

Here is a list of medical clinics and hospitals in Rio de Janeiro:

- **Hospital Copa D'Or** (<https://www.rededorsaoluiz.com.br/hospital/copador>) - Address: Rua Figueiredo de Magalhães, 875 – Copacabana, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 22031-011 - Phone: +55 (21) 2545-3600
- **Hospital Rio Laranjeiras** (<https://www.redehospitalcasa.com.br/hospital-casa-rio-laranjeiras>) - Address: R. das Laranjeiras, 72 – Laranjeiras, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 22240-000 - Phone: +55 (21) 2555-2000
- **Hospital Israelita Albert Sabin** (<http://www.hias.com.br/>) - Address: Rua Professor Gabizo, 319 – Maracanã, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 20271-065 - Phone: +55 (21) 2176-8800
- **São Lucas Hospital-Copacabana** (<https://saolucascopacabana.com.br/pt>) - Address: Condomínio de Hemodinâmica – Tv. Frederico Pamplona, 32 – Copacabana, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 22061-080 - Phone: +55 (21) 2545-4000

- **Hospital Samaritano Barra** (<http://www.hospitalsamaritano.com.br/>) - Address: Av. Jorge Curi, 550 – Barra da Tijuca, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 22775-001 - Phone: +55 (21) 3263-1000
- **Ibogaina Rio de Janeiro** (<https://prime.tratamentoibogaina.com/ibogaina-tratamento-da-dependencia-quimica--rio-de-janeiro-rj>) - Address: R. Bom Pastor, 295 – Tijuca, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 20521-060 - Phone: +55 (21) 2159-2300
- **Hospital Unimed Rio** (<http://www.unimedrio.com.br/>) - Address: Av. Ayrton Senna, 2550 – Barra da Tijuca, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 22775-003 - Phone: 0800 031 3861

Public Hospitals of the State of Rio de Janeiro

- **Hospital Estadual Getúlio Vargas** - Address: Av. Lobo Júnior, 2293 – Penha Circular, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 21070-061 - Phone: +55 (21) 2334-7856
- **Hospital Universitário Pedro Ernesto** - Address: Boulevard 28 de Setembro, 77 – Vila Isabel, Rio de Janeiro – RJ, 20551-030 - Phone: +55 (21) 2868-8000

Stay safe



Note: Caution is recommended when traveling to Rio de Janeiro because of the high crime rates. Travel to informal housing developments (commonly known as “favelas”) is very dangerous even if you are accompanied by people who know the areas, such as tour guides, due to the armed conflict between drug trafficking factions and illegal militias that takes place in these areas.

Travel advisories

Australia (<https://www.smartraveller.gov.au/destinations/americas/brazil>) • Canada (<http://travel.gc.ca/destinations/brazil>) • Germany (https://www.auswaertiges-amt.de/de/service/laender/brasilien-node/brasiliensicherheit/201092#content_1) • India (<https://mea.gov.in/advisories-details.htm?40/Travel+Advisory+for+Indian+nationals+travelling+to+Brazil>) • Ireland (<https://www.dfa.ie/travel/travel-advice/a-z-list-of-countries/brazil/>) • New Zealand (<https://www.safetravel.govt.nz/brazil/>) • United Kingdom (<https://www.gov.uk/foreign-travel-advice/brazil/>) • United States (<https://travel.state.gov/content/travel/en/traveladvisories/traveladvisories/brazil-travel-advisory.html>)

(Information last updated 06 Sep 2025)

Rio de Janeiro's reputation as a dangerous city was cemented internationally by the critically acclaimed movie *Cidade de Deus* — a reputation that's not entirely unwarranted.

Although most visitors to the city have a great time with no incidents, **Rio can be dangerous**. As a traveler, even if you don't leave the "Zona Sul" (which includes Copacabana, Ipanema, Leblon, Gávea, Jardim Botânico, Flamengo, Laranjeiras, Botafogo, Urca) or Western Suburbs (Barra, Recreio), you may experience a palpable tension over security.



Armed robbery taking place.

Generally, tourists (also called "gringos", which is not derogatory but means "outsiders") and teenagers are considered "easy" targets for criminals. Day-to-day living has also been affected by this. For example, banks all have security doors and armed guards. Rio *can* be a dangerous city and it is wise to follow the advice below even if it seems exaggerated.

Don't walk around with lots of money in your pocket. ATMs are everywhere (stick to the ones inside shopping centers) and credit/debit cards are widely accepted. But don't walk around without any money: you may need something to give to the bad guys in case you are mugged. Not

having money to give a mugger can be dangerous as they may get angry and resort to violence. An excellent idea is to buy a "capanga" (literally meaning bodyguard), that is, a small pouch worn under your shirt, normally used to carry your wallet and keys.

Avoid showing visible signs of wealth (cameras, jewelry, etc.) at any time of the day, as these attract attention. Thieves have been known to run past targets and tear off necklaces, rings, and earrings without stopping. Earrings are particularly dangerous as tearing them off often harms the owner.

The lines 1 (orange) and 4 (yellow) of subway (which cross Tijuca, the downtown area, the South Zone, and Barra da Tijuca) are very safe, so it is recommended to use them if you want to go from one place to another - these two lines are interconnected at General Osório station, in Ipanema. The line 2 (green) of the metro is not exactly dangerous, but also is not as safe as the other lines, since it crosses many neighborhoods of North Zone and passes near several slums along its way.

Dangerous areas

Avoid the downtown area, especially *Saara* (a large street shopping region in the city center), at night. Although the downtown is a relatively safe place during the day, after-dark all the people who work there have already gone home. If you are going to a theater or a show, do not wander in those streets by night. It is better to take a taxi directly from your hotel to your final destination and back rather than going around seeking for public transport. Go to the Ipanema beach, which is relatively safe at night as long as you don't stand out as an obvious tourist. In general, crowded areas with good lighting are safer, and you should avoid dark, empty places.

On Sunday, most shops are closed and their security guards are absent, so the neighborhood Centro (downtown) is not safe in the daytime. Also, even the bigger streets in Copacabana are less safe after dark so the beach walk is probably the best option.

In the morning, especially before the police arrive, if you are walking or jogging on, Copacabana should be considered unsafe. Even with people around, joggers are popular targets for mugging. If you plan on jogging make sure not to wear anything that may tempt a mugger (watches, iPhones, etc.) and if you can, wait until after 10AM.

Don't walk along the banks of the Rodrigo de Freitas Lagoon (South Zone) after dark, you might get robbed.

When in downtown during the rush hour, be aware of pickpockets as in any other big city center. The difference in Rio is that the pickpocket can often be a bit violent: one of them pushing you forward in the bus or to the ground in the street while another one takes your wallet and runs away. It's not that usual or as bad as it sounds, but try to avoid being in real danger by reacting strongly as these guys often operate in armed groups (2–5 people), some unnoticed by you.

Buses on the South Zone are fairly safe as well, but they can be quite crowded. Inside a bus, being mugged is always a threat: less so but still possible in the South and tourist zones. Don't use a phone while sat next to an open window since it can get snatched from your hand. In the subway, it is very unlikely though, which is one extra point to the subway!

The suburban rail is generally not useful for tourists. If you do take it, note that trains may not come all that frequently, especially on weekends and holidays, and they tend to be filled with hawkers selling various cheap goods and, worse, evangelical preachers. Although the trains themselves are generally safe, a lot of the stations aren't, such as Jacarezinho, Barros Filho, Costa Barros (on the Belford Roxo (purple) line), Parada de Lucas and Vigário Geral (on the Saracuruna (orange) line). There are many sections of the suburban rail system that cross favelas; under no circumstances take photographs on these sections.

There are around 700 favelas in the city and some of them can potentially be unsafe: and there is always one near you. These are easily recognized by their expansive brick walls, and are often on a hillside. The slums grew from being impoverished neighborhoods. They were known for being ruled by drug lords prior to a concerted effort to retake them by the police. For the more adventurous, some favelas are amazingly huge, and a new experience for some—there are some travel agencies who take people on tours there. The tour operators have "safe-conduct pacts" with the local drug dealers. If you try to get a tour without using one of those agencies **think carefully** about whether your guide is reputable. Despite the pacifying efforts, most favelas do not have a permanent police presence, so there is often no recourse for a traveller who is ambushed by a drug baron's guards.

Mugging

Should you find yourself being mugged, follow standard advice: **Don't resist or do anything to aggravate the muggers.** Try not to stare in their faces as they might think you are memorizing their appearance. Eyes to the ground is probably your best bet. Let them take anything they want (keep your arms limp). Afterwards, leave the scene quickly but calmly (don't run in panic screaming for the police).

Scams

In the area around the Copacabana beach (and maybe in the city center), the tourist should be aware of the **shoe shining scam**. The tourist will be approached by a shoeshiner and to their astonishment discover a large, dirty blot on their shoes (which is actually shoe polish or mustard but looks like quite something else). The tourist is typically shown to a chair and has their shoes or sandals cleaned. Once the service has been completed, the outrageous price of somewhere around R\$1000 or more is revealed. At this point, muscular friends of the shoeshiner typically appear to "oversee" the completion of the transaction.



On weekends, beaches are watched by helicopters 

Police

In Brazil, every state has two police forces: the Civil (*Polícia Civil*) and Military (*Polícia Militar*). Only the latter wear uniform (in Rio, it is navy blue). The city of Rio also has an unarmed Civil Guard, dressed in khaki. Policemen can usually be trusted, but corruption in Brazil is still rampant and a few officers may try to extort you or demand a little bribe. When this happens, it

is usually very subtle, and the officer may typically say something about "some for the beer" (*cervejinha*). If you are not willing, refuse and ask for another officer. Don't ever try to bribe a policeman on your own; most of them are honest and you might end up in jail.

The local emergency dial number is *190*.

Explosives

At night, especially after traffic has died down, you may hear what sounds like fireworks and explosions. This is not as menacing as it sounds, though it is still indicative of somebody up to no good. These are often firecrackers set-off as signals in the favelas. It might mean that a drug shipment has arrived and is in-transit or that the police are making a raid into the favela. It is a signal to gang operatives who act as lookouts and surrogate police to be extra-vigilant. However, real shoot-outs may occur, especially on weekends. If you are on the street and you hear a shooting, find shelter in the nearest shop or restaurant.

For your safety, cross at the crosswalks, and watch for cars even if they have a red light.

Carjacking

Carjacking can be a threat too, especially if you are outside the tourist areas and after dark. It is perfectly acceptable (even if not exactly legal) not to stop at the traffic lights if there is nobody else on the street and you feel it's okay to go (if there are no other cars). You will see even police doing this. Some major motorways such as *Linha Amarela* (Yellow Line: connects the west zone (*Barra da Tijuca*) to the north zone - may be your way to *Norte Shopping* for example) and *Linha Vermelha* (Red Line - the main connection from the International Airport) are strongly avoided late at night. Both motorways are surrounded by favelas, so carjacking is usual and shoot-outs may occur between rival drug lords or between drug lords and the police. If you rent a car, be aware of all these issues. As a tourist, it may be better not to rent one anyway, as if you get lost and go to a bad neighborhood (and again, there will always be one near you), you will most likely be in trouble.

If you want to go to a traditional *escola de samba* (samba school), *Mangueira* is a good place. This is close to a favela, so you should go with a guide accordingly. If you do have a trustful Brazilian friend that can take you, that's excellent. Ask them to take you to *Maracanã* as well to watch a football (soccer) match! Yet exercise great caution if you go by yourself especially if two of the local Rio teams are playing (Flamengo, Fluminense, Botafogo, and Vasco). These matches can be very exciting but also very dangerous especially if between Flamengo and Botafogo or Vasco. If it looks like the team for which the fans around you are cheering is losing, it is wise to leave the stadium before the match ends. You don't want to be in the middle of a very angry bunch of football fans when they all cram out of the stadium.

Cope

The Rio Times is the only English language news publication dedicated to the English speaking foreign community living and traveling in Rio de Janeiro. It is published weekly online, covering Rio's politics, business, real estate, sports, entertainment, and travel, and offers classified ads and a daily nightlife guide.

- **Lavamaq's**, Praia do Flamengo, 118 - Flamengo (*two blocks south of Metro Catete*), 21 2557–5965. Self-service laundry, R\$25 wash and dry.

Consulates General

-  **Argentina** (<http://www.crioj.mrecic.gov.ar/>), Praia de Botafogo 228, Sobreloja 201, Botafogo, ☎ +55 21 2553-1646, fax: +55 21 2552-4191, crioj@mrecic.gov.ar (mailto:crioj@mrecic.gov.ar).
-  **Australia** (<http://www.dfat.gov.au/missions/countries/brri.html>), Avenida Presidente Wilson, 231, Centro, 23rd Floor, ☎ +55 21 3824-4624, fax: +55 21 2262-4247.
-  **China** (<http://riodejaneiro.china-consulate.org/>), Rua Muniz Barreto 715, Botafogo, ☎ +55 21 3237-6614, fax: +55 21 2551-5736, chinaconsul_rj_br@mfa.gov.cn (mailto:chinaconsul_rj_br@mfa.gov.cn).
-  **Egypt** (http://www.mfa.gov.eg/arabic/embassies/Egyptian_Consulate_brazil/Pages/Default.aspx), Rua Muniz Barreto 741, Botafogo, ☎ +55 21 2554-6318, fax: +55 21 2552-8997, consuladodoegito@yahoo.com (mailto:consuladodoegito@yahoo.com).
-  **France** (<http://riodejaneiro.ambafrance-br.org/>), Avenida Presidente Antônio Carlos, 58, Centro, ☎ +55 21 3974-6699, fax: +55 21 3974-6864, consulatrio@rionet.com.br (mailto:consulatrio@rionet.com.br).
-  **Germany** (<http://www.rio-de-janeiro.diplo.de/>), Avenida Presidente Antônio Carlos, 58, Centro, ☎ +55 21 3380-3700, fax: +55 21 3380-3709.
-  **Italy** (http://www.consriodejaneiro.esteri.it/Consolato_RioDeJaneiro), Avenida Presidente Antonio Carlos, 40 Castelo, ☎ +55 21 3534-1315, fax: +55 21 2262-6348, con.riodejaneiro@cert.esteri.it (mailto:con.riodejaneiro@cert.esteri.it).
-  **Japan** (<http://www.rio.br.emb-japan.go.jp/>), Praia do Flamengo, 200-10 andar, ☎ +55 21 3461-9595, fax: +55 21 3235-2241.
-  **Romania** (<http://riodejaneiro.mae.ro/>), Rua Cosme Velho nr.526 - Bairro Cosme Velho, CEP 22241-091, ☎ +55 21 3495 8706, +55 21 994 665 056, +55 21 994 629 084, +55 21 3496 8661, riodejaneiro@mae.ro (mailto:riodejaneiro@mae.ro). General Consulate (updated May 2025 |)
-  **Russia** (<http://www.consrio.mid.ru/>), Rua Prof. Azevedo Marques, 50, Leblon, ☎ +55 21 2274-0097, fax: +55 21 2294-4945, consulado.russia@radnet.com.br (mailto:consulado.russia@radnet.com.br).
-  **Spain** (<http://www.exteriores.gob.es/Consulados/RIODEJANEIRO/es/Paginas/inicio.aspx>), Rua Lauro Muller, 116 Salas, ☎ +55 21 2543-3200, +55 21 2543-3112, fax: +55 21 2543-3096, cog.riodejaneiro@maec.es (mailto:cog.riodejaneiro@maec.es).
-  **United Kingdom** (<http://ukinbrazil.fco.gov.uk/en>), Praia do Flamengo 284/2 andar, ☎ +55 21 2555-9600, fax: +55 21 2555-9670, bcg.rj@fco.gov.uk (mailto:bcg.rj@fco.gov.uk).
-  **United States of America** (<https://br.usembassy.gov/embassy-consulates/riodejaneiro/>), Avenida Presidente Wilson, 147, Centro, ☎ +55 21 3823-2000, +55 21 3823-2029, acsrio@state.gov (mailto:acsrio@state.gov).

Go next

Grande Rio

- **Niterói** – 15km from downtown. It has a wonderful unique view of Rio and an intriguing contemporary art museum, which looks like a UFO (designed by famous architect Oscar

Niemeyer). Also, it has one of the state's most beautiful beaches, Itacoatiara, which can be reached by the bus #38. From Rio to Niterói it's a short ferry ride or you go by bus.

- **São Gonçalo** – 25km from downtown. The biggest city of the Leste Metropolitano region, with the second largest population in the state.
- **Duque de Caxias** – 20km from downtown. The largest city of Baixada Fluminense, neighboring to the Rio de Janeiro's North Zone.
- **Maricá** – 55km from downtown. The last municipality on the sea coast of Grande Rio to the east. It has several lagoons and a single strip of sand that extends along almost the entire shoreline of the municipality.
- **Rio Bonito** – 75km from downtown. A peripheral municipality, with a small population and wide rural areas with lots of nature. It is the easternmost municipality in the metropolitan area of Rio de Janeiro.
- **Cachoeiras de Macacu** – 90km from downtown. The most northeastern municipality of Rio metropolitan area, it is another peripheral municipality which has become an attraction for trekking, mountaineering, rappelling and other types of extreme sports and ecotourism. Part of the Três Picos State Park is in the municipality. There are dozens of waterfalls of extraordinary beauty. The bus company *1001* goes for around R\$45 (Oct 2025), departing from the Rio's long-distance bus station (*Rodoviária Novo Rio*).
- **Guapimirim** – 75km from downtown. The most northeastern municipality in Baixada Fluminense, at the foot of the mountain range known as *Serra dos Órgãos*, a section of a longer mountain range called *Serra do Mar*.
- **Paracambi** – 70km from downtown by railway (80km by road). The most northwestern municipality of Baixada Fluminense and of the metropolitan area, at the foot of *Serra das Araras*, a more western section of *Serra do Mar*. The bus company *UTIL* has a route to the municipality for around R\$40 (Sep 2023) departing from *Rodoviária Novo Rio*.
- **Itaguaí** – 70km from downtown. Another peripheral municipality, bathed by the Sepetiba Bay, it is one of the last coastal municipalities of the metropolitan agglomeration of Rio to the west.

On the southeastern coast of Rio State

- **Saquarema** – 95 km from downtown Rio. A predominantly tourist city with beautiful beaches, in the lakes region. It is known as "The national surfing capital". Further attractions are waterfalls, cascades, mountains and an archaeological site.
- **Búzios** – 170 km. It's a small peninsula with several nice beaches, an abundance of night clubs and the lowest rainfall in the state of Rio. It's nickname is "Saint-Brazilian Tropez".
- **Cabo Frio** – 170 km. A popular tourist destination. It's famous for its beautiful beaches with fine white sand and crystal clear waters.
- **Arraial do Cabo** – 170 km. It's a small town near Búzios. Its beaches have the most beautiful turquoise waters of Rio de Janeiro state. Beaches like Forno and Prainhas do Atalaia are surrounded by virgin lush green coastal vegetation and have clear blue waters similar to the Caribbean ones.

In the northwest

- **Miguel Pereira** – 120 km. It's famous for its exuberant nature, cool climate and tranquility, for those who want to escape the hassle of big cities. One of the most visited spots is Lake Javary, where you can ride a pedal boat and breathe the fresh mountain air. The intercity buses of *Util* have rides for around R\$40 (Dec 2021).

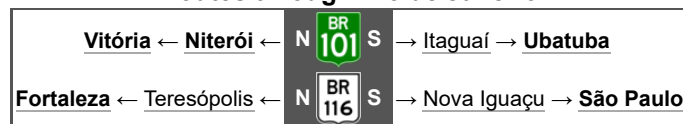
In the north

- **Petrópolis** – 70 km. In the mountains outside and a good place to cool down when Rio becomes too hot. It's known as an "Imperial City", the place chosen by Brazil's Royalty to spend the summer. There's a nice imperial museum. The city also hosts one of Brazil's first breweries which can be visited.
- **Serra dos Órgãos National Park**, Parque Nacional da Serra dos Órgãos — National park in the mountains.
- **Teresópolis** — Another mountain town, near Petrópolis.

In the west

- **Mangaratiba** – 100km from downtown Rio. Bathed by the Sepetiba Bay, it has several amazing beaches, being also an attraction for trekking, mountaineering and ecotourism. Moreover, it is one of the municipalities (the other being Angra dos Reis) from where ships to Ilha Grande depart. The bus company *Costa Verde* goes for around R\$55 (Oct 2025), departing from the Rio's long-distance bus station (*Rodoviária Novo Rio*).
- **Ilha Grande** – 180 km. It's noted for its scenic beauty, unspoilt tropical beaches, luxuriant vegetation and rugged landscape. You will enjoy hiking.

Routes through Rio de Janeiro



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